

PAPER_568: Wavelength-Dependent Opacity $\kappa_\lambda(\lambda)$ in the UQFF Olbers Framework

Unified Quantum Field Framework (UQFF)

Daniel T. Murphy • UQFF Research Consortium • 2026
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§1 Abstract

The UQFF Olbers resolution in PAPER_564–566 is wavelength-independent: every photon receives the same DPM/VDS/BSFG suppression. In reality, dust and vacuum absorption depend strongly on photon wavelength — the night sky is not equally dark at all wavelengths. This paper introduces **wavelength-dependent opacity** $\kappa_\lambda(\lambda)$ into the 26-shell framework, yielding a **spectral Olbers resolution**: the sky is dark in the UV but slightly brighter in the far-IR. The UQFF [SSq] factor also acquires a spectral form.

$$B_n(\lambda) = \frac{n_{\text{star}} L_{\text{star}}(\lambda)}{4\pi c (1+z_n)^4} \cdot e^{-\kappa_\lambda(\lambda) \Delta r} \cdot n_H \Delta r \cdot e^{-[\text{SSq}](\lambda) \cdot n/26}$$

§2 Classical Dust Opacity Power Law

Standard interstellar dust opacity:

$$\kappa_\lambda(\lambda) = \kappa_0 \left(\frac{\lambda}{\lambda_0} \right)^{\beta}$$

with $\beta \approx -2$ in the UV-optical regime (Draine 2003). Reference values:

Band	λ	$\kappa_{\lambda} / \kappa_V$
UV	100 nm	~ 10
V	550 nm	1.0 (reference)
NIR	2 μm	~ 0.03
FIR	100 μm	$\sim 2 \times 10^{-4}$

The universe is far more opaque in the UV than in the far-IR — explaining why the UV night sky is darker than the faint IR glow.

§3 UQFF Spectral [SSq]

Within UQFF, the 26-dimensional vacuum coupling $[\text{SSq}]$ acquires a spectral form via the VDS photon-wavelength modulation (PAPER_429):

$$[\text{SSq}](\lambda) = [\text{SSq}]_0 \cdot \left(\frac{\lambda_{\text{opt}}}{\lambda}\right)^{1/26}$$

with $\lambda_{\text{opt}} = 550$ nm and $[\text{SSq}]_0 = 0.507$. This gives:

Band	λ	$[\text{SSq}](\lambda)$
UV (100 nm)	UV	$0.507 \times (550/100)^{1/26} \approx 0.574$
V (550 nm)	Optical	0.507
NIR (2 μm)	NIR	$0.507 \times (0.55/2.0)^{1/26} \approx 0.460$
FIR (100 μm)	FIR	$0.507 \times (0.55/100)^{1/26} \approx 0.370$

The UV receives *stronger* [SSq] suppression; FIR receives *weaker* suppression — consistent with the IR EBL being the dominant contribution to $B_{\text{sky,obs}}$.

§4 Spectral Shell Brightness

Combined spectral opacity and VDS suppression per shell:

$$B_n(\lambda) = \frac{n_{\text{star}}(\lambda)}{4\pi c (1+z_n)^4} L_{\text{star}}(\lambda) \Delta r \cdot e^{-\kappa_{\lambda}(\lambda_{\text{em}}) n_H \Delta r} \cdot e^{-[\text{SSq}](\lambda) n/26}$$

where $\lambda_{\text{em}} = \lambda_{\text{obs}}(1+z_n)$ (blueshifted emitted wavelength), $n_H = 1.6 \times 10^{-7} \text{ m}^{-3}$ (mean hydrogen column density).

Integrated sky brightness per wavelength:

$$B_{\text{sky}}(\lambda) = \sum_{n=1}^{26} B_n(\lambda)$$

§5 Spectral Olbers Prediction

Integrating over all wavelengths:

$$B_{\text{sky}}^{\text{total}} = \int_0^\infty B_{\text{sky}}(\lambda) d\lambda$$

Key spectral features:

- **UV ($\lambda < 200 \text{ nm}$):** Strong opacity + enhanced [SSq] $\rightarrow$ nearly zero contribution
- **Optical ($\lambda \approx 550 \text{ nm}$):** Standard [SSq] = 0.507 suppression (PAPER_564)
- **NIR/FIR ($\lambda > 1 \text{ }\mu\text{m}$):** Reduced opacity + reduced [SSq] $\rightarrow$ dominant contributor to EBL

This explains the observational fact (EBL measurements) that the extragalactic background light peaks in the far-IR ($\sim 100\text{--}140 \text{ }\mu\text{m}$) and optical.

§6 Numerical Estimates

For the optical band ($\lambda = 550 \text{ nm}$, $n_H \Delta r = \text{column depth}$):

$$\tau_V = \kappa_V n_H \Delta r \approx 10^{-7}, \text{ per shell} \quad \text{intergalactic medium is highly transparent}$$

The dust opacity is negligible in the intergalactic medium; the dominant suppression comes from VDS [SSq] and the DPM cascade. The wavelength-dependent correction is order $(\lambda_{\text{opt}}/\lambda)^{1/26}$, giving a $\sim 20\%$ correction across the full optical range.

§7 Testable Predictions

1. **IR excess:** B_{sky} peaks at $\lambda \sim 100 \text{ }\mu\text{m}$ (FIR) due to reduced [SSq] suppression — consistent with COBE/Herschel EBL measurements.
2. **UV opacity edge:** $B_{\text{sky}}(\text{UV})$ should be suppressed by a factor $\sim e^{-[\text{SSq}]_{\text{UV}} \cdot 26/2}$ relative to optical — testable with GALEX UV background.
3. **[SSq] spectral slope:** The spectral index $d \ln [\text{SSq}] / d \ln \lambda = -1/26$ — a unique UQFF prediction (compared to $\beta = -2$ dust law).

§8 Builds On / Addresses

Paper	Role
PAPER_564	DPM 26-shell baseline (wavelength-independent — extended here)
PAPER_565	VDS [SSq] value (acquires spectral form here)
PAPER_566	Gap analysis — this is Missing Extension 2

PAPER_568 — Star Magic UQFF Framework — QS 5/5